

'Rudra' are inflected for these categories, in accordance with the rule in Figure 2.

x	Mod. ⁿ	N		y
			$\begin{bmatrix} \alpha \text{ number} \\ \beta \text{ gender} \\ \gamma \text{ case} \end{bmatrix}$	
1	2	3	4	
1	2	3	4	
			$\begin{bmatrix} \alpha \text{ number} \\ \beta \text{ gender} \\ \gamma \text{ case} \end{bmatrix}$	
				oblig.

The adscript *n* is to be interpreted as referring to one or more modifiers.

Figure 2. Modifier agreement rule.

Since the agreement rules have been thoroughly described, as by Delbrück (1893, 1900), they will not be enlarged on here. In Chapter 5, when the categories are treated, archaisms will be noted. Notable among these is the treatment of "neuter plurals" as collectives, a relic of the earlier inflectional system in which the ending *-a* indicated a "mass form", whether it subsequently marked a singular feminine nominative, such as Lat. *rosa* 'rose', a singular masculine nominative, such as Lat. *nauta* 'sailor', or a plural neuter nominative-accusative, such as Lat. *dona* 'gifts'. The agreement rules may be based on the ancient collective regarded as a singular, as in the Greek verb, or on semantically determined collectives, as in Germanic. When modifiers refer to nouns of different genders, they are inflected in the neuter plural, as in the following Old Saxon example (Heliand 458):

32. Giuuitun im thō thiu gōdun tuuē, Ioseph endi Maria
 went for-themselves then the good two Joseph and Mary
 beđiu fon Bethleem
 both from Bethlehem
 'That excellent pair, Joseph and Mary, then went away from Bethlehem.'

Here the neuter plural endings on *thiu*, *tuuē*, and *beđiu* are regulated by a rule which reflects the earlier congruence pattern (Lehmann 1957, 1958), though the neuter plural has taken over the function of the collective, which in late PIE was expressed by means of the *a* ending. In Greek,

neuter plural subjects still show the earlier collective force through this agreement with singular verb forms. A precise statement of the agreement rules would accordingly be complex, though the facts are well described in the standard handbooks.

The agreement rule which regulates the proper number and person inflections on finite verb forms is stated as in Figure 3.

x	NP-Nom.	V	y
			$\begin{bmatrix} \alpha \text{ person} \\ \beta \text{ number} \\ \gamma \text{ gender} \end{bmatrix}$
1	2	3	4
x	NP-Nom.	V	y
			$\begin{bmatrix} \alpha \text{ person} \\ \beta \text{ number} \\ \gamma \text{ gender} \end{bmatrix}$
1	2	3	4
			oblig.

Figure 3. Verb agreement rule.

By this rule a subject, whether noun or pronoun, would regulate the person and number affixes on finite verbs; when appropriate, as in the Latin perfect passive or the Russian past, the gender of the subjects would also be involved.

Agreement in this way would be determined for nominal modifiers and for finite verb forms. For both, the inherent categorial features of the nouns and pronouns in question determine the affixes marking the agreement forms.

3.5. Attributive Genitives.

As Delbrück pointed out (1900:102-103), the position of the attributive genitive is the same as that of the attributive adjective. A striking example is given from the Old English legal language (Delbrück 1900:102):

33. oðres mannes huses dura
 'the door of the house of the other man'

Like the adjective construction, the attributive-genitive construction may have the modifier postposed for marked effect, as is *sómasya* in SB 3.9.4.15 (Delbrück 1878:43):